

What is Azure Test Plans?

Azure Test Plans is a comprehensive test management tool within Azure DevOps that provides all the capabilities needed for planned manual testing, user acceptance testing, exploratory testing, and gathering stakeholder feedback.

Azure Test Plans offers powerful tools for driving quality and collaboration throughout the development process. This browser-based test management solution supports both manual and automated testing workflows, enabling teams to ensure software quality at every stage of delivery.

Key benefits include end-to-end traceability from requirements to test cases, seamless integration with CI/CD pipelines through Azure Pipelines, and rich reporting dashboards that provide visibility into testing progress and quality metrics.

Manual and Exploratory Testing

Planned Manual Testing allows teams to organize tests into test plans and test suites by areas of ownership. Testers can run manual test cases using the web-based test runner, which captures detailed results including pass/fail status, comments, and attachments.

Exploratory Testing enables testers to explore the application without predefined test cases. Using the Test & Feedback browser extension, testers can capture screenshots, screen recordings, and notes during their testing sessions. All findings are automatically linked to work items.

User Acceptance Testing (UAT) provides mechanisms for stakeholders and end users to validate that the software meets business requirements. UAT test plans can be assigned to specific users who may not be part of the development team.

Stakeholder Feedback allows product owners and other stakeholders to provide structured feedback on applications through the feedback extension, capturing rich data including images and annotations.

Automated Testing Integration

Azure Test Plans integrates with Azure Pipelines to support automated testing as part of CI/CD workflows. Test cases can be associated with automated test methods, allowing them to be executed automatically during build and release pipelines.

Key automation capabilities include:

- Associate test plans with build or release pipelines for continuous testing
- Run automated tests as part of the deployment process
- Capture and publish test results from various test frameworks
- Review test results through built-in pipeline reports and dashboards

Supported test frameworks include NUnit, xUnit, MSTest, JUnit, and many others through the Visual Studio Test task and Publish Test Results task in Azure Pipelines.

Test Impact Analysis helps identify which tests need to run based on code changes, reducing the time needed for regression testing while maintaining quality coverage.

Traceability and Reporting

Azure Test Plans provides end-to-end traceability by linking test cases and test suites to user stories, features, or requirements. This ensures complete visibility into what has been tested and what gaps remain.

Traceability features include:

- Link test cases to requirements for bidirectional traceability
- Automatically associate tests with builds and releases
- Track defects found during testing back to requirements
- View requirement-based test coverage reports

Reporting and Analytics capabilities include configurable tracking charts that can be pinned to dashboards, test-specific dashboard widgets showing pass rates and trends, built-in reports for tracking testing progress across sprints, and integration with Power BI for advanced custom analytics.

Progress reports show test execution status across test plans, highlighting areas that need attention and providing confidence metrics for release readiness decisions.